

RAJESH DAMMALA

Morrisville, NC | rajesh.dammala@gmail.com | 425-229-0060 | linkedin.com/in/rajesh-dammala

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven technical support engineering leader with 16+ years driving Tier-3 resolution excellence, escalation management, and operational scale across enterprise SaaS platforms. Built and led organizations of 15–32 engineers delivering 24/7 mission-critical support for 20+ production services. Proven track record reducing engineering escalations by 32%, automating 30–35% of incident resolution, and translating support signals into product roadmap priorities. Deep hands-on expertise with SQL, REST APIs, observability (KQL/App Insights), and complex integrations. Skilled executive communicator who bridges Customer Experience and Engineering to drive systemic reliability improvements.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Tier-3 Org Strategy & Scaling
- Enterprise Customer Support
- SQL, REST APIs, Postman/cURL
- AIOps & Automation (30-35% auto-resolution)
- Executive Communication (QBRs/MBRs)
- Post-Incident Reviews & Systemic Prevention
- Escalation & Incident Management
- Cross-Functional Leadership (Eng/Product/CX)
- Observability: KQL, App Insights, Log Analytics
- Org Design, Hiring & Career Pathing
- SLA/SLO/SLI Frameworks
- CI/CD Pipeline Management (ADO/Git)

SELECTED IMPACT

- Architected Azure SRE Agent platform achieving 30–35% automated incident resolution, reclaiming ~150+ engineering hours/year and reducing escalations to product teams.
- Redesigned escalation framework with severity models and response protocols, reducing mean time to resolution (MTTR) by 32% across 20+ mission-critical services.
- Eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and rationalized 500+ redundant alerts, dramatically improving signal-to-noise ratio for engineering teams.
- Authored 175+ troubleshooting playbooks in 5 months, standardizing triage workflows and reducing repeat Tier-3 escalations by 40%.
- Drove operational efficiency from 85% to 98% through process redesign, tooling investments, and data-driven performance management.
- Delivered executive incident summaries, trend analysis, and strategic recommendations in QBRs/MBRs used by VP-level leadership for investment decisions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Escalations Manager — Xbox CXT SRE

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra/Allyis) | Redmond, WA (Remote from Morrisville, NC) | May 2021 – Present

- Own escalation management for high-severity incidents across 20+ mission-critical Xbox support services; serve as executive escalation point for cross-functional resolution.
- Built and scaled Tier-3 technical support function from ground up — defined operating model, severity frameworks, SLA protocols, and career leveling for engineering-adjacent roles.
- Partner with Engineering and Product leadership to translate recurring incident patterns into prioritized product/platform improvements (e.g., identified 60% ADF trigger failures !' drove pipeline redesign).
- Lead data analysis of Tier-3 trends using KQL/Kusto and Power BI dashboards; present actionable insights to VP-level stakeholders in monthly/quarterly business reviews.
- Established AIOps-driven incident detection and automation using Azure App Insights, Logic Apps, and custom SRE Agent — reducing manual triage workload by 30-35%.
- Defined and standardized incident management frameworks including severity models, response protocols, and post-incident review processes driving systemic prevention.
- Drive cross-functional collaboration with Customer Success, Engineering, and Product teams to ensure seamless technical experience for enterprise customers.

Azure Support Technical Lead

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Redmond, WA | Nov 2016 – May 2021

- Led team of 15 engineers supporting enterprise Azure customers; owned hiring, coaching, performance management, and career development across the org.
- Resolved complex integration and platform issues for enterprise accounts using SQL, REST APIs, logs, and cross-service debugging — served as final escalation point.
- Partnered with Product teams to influence supportability improvements; championed 200+ bugs and feature enhancements during platform onboarding phases.
- Drove Azure Chat Support initiatives and cross-functional collaboration across Microsoft CSS organization.

Operations Lead — Azure LiveSite Operations

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Hyderabad, India | Redmond, WA | May 2012 – Nov 2016

- Built and led 32-person global operations team (12 senior + 20 service engineers across Hyderabad & Redmond) — designed org structure, shifts, and competency models.
- Led deep-dive technical investigations into complex production issues at cluster-to-blade level across Azure platform infrastructure.
- Created PowerShell automation frameworks saving thousands of manual hours annually; drove operational tooling strategy.
- Managed incident lifecycle, change management, and SLA compliance for Azure LiveSite operations.

Systems Analyst / Data Center Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Hammond, IN | Sep 2009 – Nov 2011

- Enterprise server builds, cluster configuration, and large-scale data migrations supporting production infrastructure.
- Applied patches, service packs, and configured servers with packaged tools across data center operations.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.E., Computer Science Engineering — JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

- AZ-900 Azure Fundamentals
- Microsoft 70-533/70-534: Implementing Azure Infrastructure Solutions
- TechMahindra AI White Belt | Google Generative AI | Google Cloud Computing Foundations

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Observability: Azure (App Insights, Log Analytics, Key Vault, Logic Apps, ADO), Kusto/KQL, Power BI

APIs & Data: REST/cURL/Postman, SQL, Webhooks, Complex Integrations

Automation: PowerShell, Bicep, CI/CD Pipelines (ADO/Git), AIOps

Frameworks: Incident Management, SLA/SLO/SLI, ITSM, Change Management, Escalation Models